THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **The Rock and the Sea, Patol Babu, Film Star, My Greatest Olympic Prize, Failure** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'I was placed here to withstand you.' A reader infers that the Rock sees itself as: 1

(a) a victim of the Sea **(b)** unaware of the Sea
(c) having a duty it is proud of **(d)** a friend of the Sea

2. The author lets Patol Babu mix up his shopping list mainly to show that he: 1

(a) was lost in thoughts of acting **(b)** was short of money
(c) disliked shopping **(d)** was forgetful by nature

3. Owens felt that Long's advice was surprising because Long: 1

(a) was his coach
(b) was a judge
(c) was a competitor who could be hurt by his success
(d) did not speak English

4. The poet's repeated use of 'failure is like...' images mostly serves to: 1

(a) confuse the reader **(b)** change the topic
(c) slow the poem **(d)** show many sides of one idea

5. Which of these is an example of hyperbole-like grandeur in the Sea's claim? 1

(a) watching continents rise and sink **(b)** a small wave
(c) a seashell **(d)** a cloud

6. 'Make a go of it' is closest to: 1

(a) cancel it **(b)** avoid it
(c) go away **(d)** become successful at it

7. An inference about the crowd's reaction to Owens is that: 1

(a) they were hostile in all cases **(b)** talent won their respect
(c) they left early **(d)** they ignored him

8. The poem is didactic, meaning it: 1

(a) tells a story **(b)** teaches a lesson **(c)** only describes **(d)** only entertains

9. The Sea's game metaphor makes its power seem: 1

(a) small **(b)** weak **(c)** casual and vast **(d)** temporary

10. 'Excruciating' as used in such stories means: 1

(a) boring **(b)** funny
(c) extremely painful **(d)** silent

11. The best title alternative for the story would be: 1

(a) A Day of Rain **(b)** A Lost Medal
(c) The Marathon **(d)** A Friend on the Field

12. Which quality is NOT recommended in the poem? 1

(a) giving in to despair **(b)** hope
(c) patience **(d)** determination

13. The Rock's admission that the Sea is lovely and playful is mainly used to: 1

(a) praise the Sea **(b)** beg for mercy
(c) show that charm will not move it **(d)** change the topic

14. 'He felt mocked.' This tells us that Patol Babu: 1

(a) disliked Naresh Dutt **(b)** had hoped for a more substantial part
(c) hated films **(d)** was afraid of the camera

15. Which best describes the irony of Long's friendship? 1

(a) a German athlete befriended an American in an era of prejudice
(b) Long won gold
(c) Owens retired
(d) Owens lost the medal

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why does the poet make the Rock speak before the Sea? 2

17. Why does the author describe Patol Babu's past before the shoot? 2

18. Why does Owens call Long's act brave? 2

19. Why does the poet compare failure to many different things rather than one? 2

20. How would you describe the relationship between the Rock and the Sea? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Examine how stanza 1 establishes the Rock's character. 3

22. Analyse why the writer makes the hero collide with Patol Babu. 3

23. Analyse how the writer builds suspense before the final jump. 3

24. Analyse how the poet moves from difficulty to hope across the poem. 3

OR

Relate the poem to a modern example of resisting change. 3

25. Explain how the end leaves the reader with a lesson. 3

OR

How is the long jump used as a metaphor for life's chances? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. 'Strength without flexibility is weakness.' Discuss with reference to the poem. 5

OR

'Patol Babu is a portrait of an artist in an ordinary man.' Discuss. 5

27. 'Friendship is a greater victory than a medal.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Critically appreciate the poem 'Failure'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — **Total: 50 Marks**

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